

Date & Time functions, Fill Series (Linear Growth, Date, Auto Fill, Custom list)

1. How do you use the Today and Now functions in excel?

→ The today function returns the current system date, while the Now function returns the current date and time. These functions update automatically ~~where~~ whenever the worksheet is recalculated!

Syntax:

- =Today()

- =Now()

Example: =Today() displays today's date, and =Now() shows the current date and time. They are commonly used in reports and schedules.

② What is the difference between the date and text functions?

→ The date functions create a valid date using year, month, and day values, while the TEXT functions convert a date or number into formatted text.

Date Syntax: =Date (year, month, day)

Text Syntax: =TEXT (value, format_text)

Example: =Date (2026, 1, 22) returns a date, whereas =TEXT (TODAY (), "dd-mm-yyyy") returns a text string.

③ How would you calculate the difference between two dates in excel?

* Date differences can be calculated by subtracting one date from another. excel stores dates as serial number, so subtraction returns the number of days.

Example: $=B1 - A1$ gives days between two dates
For detailed units, the DATEDIF function can be used

Example: $=DATEDIF(A1, B1, "Y")$ calculates years between dates

④ explain how the EOMONTH function is used.

* The EOMONTH function returns the last date of a month before or after a given date.

Syntax: $=EOMONTH(\text{start_date}, \text{months})$
Positive months move forward, negative months move backward.

Example: $=EOMONTH(\text{Today}(), 0)$ returns the last day of the current month.

⑤ How can you extract the day, month, and year from a date using excel functions?

* excel provides day, MONTH, and year functions to extract date components
Syntax

$=DAY(\text{date})$

$=MONTH(\text{date})$

• = Year (date)

Example: For date 15-08-2025 Day returns 15
Month returns 8, and year returns 2025

⑥ What is the purpose of the WORKDAY function, and how is it used?

→ The workday function calculates a future or past date excluding weekends and specified holidays.

Syntax: = WORKDAY (start - date, days, [holidays])

It is commonly used for project deadlines.

Example: = WORKDAY (Today (), 10) returns the date after 10 working days.

⑦ How do you create a linear growth series using Fill Series?

→ A linear growth series increases values by a constant amount.

Enter the first value, go to Home → Fill → Series, choose linear, and specify the step value.

Example: Starting with 10 and step value 5 creates: 10, 15, 20, 25

⑧ What are the different options available in the Auto Fill feature?

→ Auto Fill provides options such as copy cells, fill series, fill formatting only, and fill without formatting.

It can fill number, dates, days, months, formulas and patterns automatically.

This feature save time and ensure consistency in data entry.

⑨ How can you create a custom list for Auto Fill in excel?

→ Custom lists allow predefined sequences like department names or priorities.

Go to File → options → advanced → edit.

Custom lists enter the list and click add. Once created, Auto Fill can recognize and extend the custom sequence automatically.

⑩ Describe a situation where you would use the NETWORKDAYS functions.

→ The NETWORKDAYS functions calculates the number of working days between two dates excluding weekends and holidays.
Syntax:

=NETWORKDAYS (start - date, end - date, [holidays])

It is useful for calculating employee attendance or project duration.